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Toh 536 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 536 in the Kangyur is a brief canonical text known in English as "The Recollection of the Name Candraprabha," with Candraprabha being the Sanskrit name meaning "Moonlight" and corresponding to the Tibetan Zla ba'i 'od. It belongs to the genre of name-recollection texts, a form of devotional and merit-generating scripture that extols the spiritual benefits of calling to mind the name of a particular buddha or bodhisattva. The text teaches that by recollecting the name Candraprabha one will remember past lives across forty thousand aeons and be protected from rebirth in the lower realms. As it stands in the Kangyur, it is a very short, self-contained piece that preserves only the concluding statement of its teaching, suggesting it may be a brief extract or condensed liturgical passage drawn from a larger scriptural context.

That light which calls to mind the Tathāgata's name will cause one to remember past lives for forty thousand aeons, and one will never fall into the lower realms. By recollecting the name Candraprabha — Moonlight — one will attain those very qualities. The recollection of the name Candraprabha is complete.

Namas sarva —

Translator's Notes

- The final line "Namas sarva" is an incomplete Sanskrit phrase, almost certainly a scribal colophon fragment meaning "Homage to all [buddhas]" or the beginning of a longer formula; the text breaks off mid-phrase and no complete reconstruction is possible from this passage alone.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.